

City of Cascade Heights

FY 2026 ADOPTED OPERATING BUDGET

Total Appropriations: **\$3.74 billion** · Population served: 412,000 · Per capita: **\$9,073**

Illustrative document prepared for the BudgetPlay participatory budgeting simulator. This is not an actual government publication.

Executive Summary

The City of Cascade Heights's FY 2026 adopted budget totals **\$3,738,000,000** across thirteen primary appropriation categories. Approximately **53%** of total appropriations are **Restricted** — funded by dedicated revenue streams (state grants, ballot-approved sales taxes, utility ratepayer fees, and bond covenants) that cannot be reallocated by the City Council. The remaining **47%** sits in the **General Fund** and is subject to annual discretionary appropriation.

Appropriations by Category

#	Category	Fund Type	FY 2026 (\$M)	% of Total
1	Police Department	General	\$480	12.8%
2	Fire & Emergency Medical Services	General	\$295	7.9%
3	Public Schools (K-12)	Restricted	\$980	26.2%
4	Streets, Roads & Bridges	Restricted	\$410	11.0%
5	Affordable Housing & Homeless Services	General	\$215	5.8%
6	Parks, Recreation & Open Space	General	\$128	3.4%
7	Public Health & Community Wellness	General	\$245	6.6%
8	Solid Waste & Recycling	Restricted	\$145	3.9%
9	Transit & Light Rail Operations	Restricted	\$310	8.3%
10	Libraries & Cultural Programs	General	\$62	1.7%
11	Workforce Development & Social Services	General	\$185	4.9%
12	General Administration & Elections	General	\$138	3.7%
13	Pension & Debt Service	Restricted	\$145	3.9%
TOTAL			\$3,738	100.0%

Dollar figures in millions. Percentages may not sum to exactly 100% due to rounding.

Category Detail

Police Department — General fund · \$480M · 12.8%

Patrol, investigations, dispatch, body-cam program.

Fire & Emergency Medical Services — General fund · \$295M · 7.9%

5 stations, EMS, hazmat, wildfire response.

Public Schools (K-12) — Restricted fund · \$980M · 26.2%

State school funding pass-through; cannot be reallocated by city council.

Streets, Roads & Bridges — Restricted fund · \$410M · 11.0%

Funded primarily by state gas-tax allocation and voter-approved bonds.

Affordable Housing & Homeless Services — General fund · \$215M · 5.8%

Rapid rehousing, navigation centers, housing trust fund.

Parks, Recreation & Open Space — General fund · \$128M · 3.4%

City parks, community centers, youth recreation, trail maintenance.

Public Health & Community Wellness — General fund · \$245M · 6.6%

Mental health crisis teams, substance use programs, public clinics.

Solid Waste & Recycling — Restricted fund · \$145M · 3.9%

Funded entirely by utility ratepayer fees.

Transit & Light Rail Operations — Restricted fund · \$310M · 8.3%

Voter-approved transit sales tax; restricted by ballot language.

Libraries & Cultural Programs — General fund · \$62M · 1.7%

12 branch libraries, civic theater, arts grants.

Workforce Development & Social Services — General fund · \$185M · 4.9%

Job training, child care subsidies, senior services.

General Administration & Elections — General fund · \$138M · 3.7%

Mayor's office, city clerk, finance, elections, IT.

Pension & Debt Service — Restricted fund · \$145M · 3.9%

Bond covenants and pension obligations; legally non-discretionary.

Fund Types Explained

General Fund (discretionary). Revenue from property tax, sales tax, fees, and intergovernmental transfers that the City Council appropriates annually. These categories are where most policy debate occurs and where reallocation is legally possible.

Restricted Fund (non-discretionary or limited). Revenue earmarked for a specific purpose by state law, voter initiative, bond covenant, or grant agreement. Examples in this budget: state K-12 education funding, voter-approved transit sales tax, utility ratepayer revenue for solid waste, and pension/debt obligations. The Council cannot freely redirect these funds to other categories.

Prepared by the Office of Management & Budget · Cascade Heights, WA · FY 2026

This document is illustrative and was generated for software testing of the BudgetPlay participatory budgeting simulator. It does not represent any real municipality's actual appropriations.